

ARUN T.

(Sole proprietary concern — Tender-Coconut & Agri-Biomass Biochar Unit)
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Ref: AT/KSPCB/CAT/2026/[]

Date: [] July 2026

To: The Member Secretary,
Kerala State Pollution Control Board,
Pattom, Thiruvananthapuram – 695004.

Copy to: 1. The Environmental Engineer, KSPCB District Office, Palakkad.
2. The Convener, Kerala State Expert Committee on Biochar.

Subject: Request for written clarification on the applicable pollution-control category (Orange vs. Green) for a proposed continuous, low-emission **agri-biomass biochar (soil-amendment) unit** at Eruthenpathy, Chittur, Palakkad, under the KSPCB revised categorisation list as on 29.12.2025 — prior to filing the Consent to Establish.

Reference:

- KSPCB Notification No. KSPCB/159/2022-SEE-3 dated 10.08.2024 (Categorization Committee, 29.05.2024) — “Charcoal Production from Coconut Shell by Pyrolysis — Orange.”
- KSPCB Revised categorisation list as on 29.12.2025.
- KSPCB “Environmental Guidelines for Charcoal Manufacturing Units” dated 02.12.2025.
- KSPCB circular dated 16.09.2025 on self-certification-based CTE/CTO.
- CPCB Directions dated 07.03.2016 (u/s 18(1)(b) of the Water Act 1974 & Air Act 1981) and 12.02.2025 — Pollution-Index categorisation methodology.

Respected Sir/Madam,

I, **Arun T.**, proprietor of a proposed sole proprietary concern, intend to establish a **continuous, low-emission biochar unit** on my owned 38-cent plot at Eruthenpathy, Chittur Taluk (Block No. 30, Survey No. 300), Palakkad. Before filing my Consent to Establish, I respectfully seek a **written clarification on the sector entry and pollution-category applicable to the unit** under the revised categorisation list as on 29.12.2025.

2. Nature of the proposed unit

- **Product:** biochar as a soil amendment / feedstock for enriched (microbe-inoculated) organic bio-fertilizer — **not** fuel charcoal, **not** activated carbon, and with **no** pyrolysis-oil or carbon-black recovery.
- **Feedstock:** mixed agri-biomass — tender-coconut husk briquettes, coconut fronds/petioles, shells and coir pith, and seasonal agri-residue. It is not a coconut-shell-only charcoal operation.
- **Capacity:** Phase-1 $\approx$ 1 t/day biochar (consent applied rated for the 2 t/day ultimate).
- **Process & controls:** closed, continuous/semi-continuous pyrolysis with a syngas afterburner/flare (self-fuelling), cyclone/dust collector, alkaline scrubber with mist eliminator and a stack meeting KSPCB norms; continuous temperature monitoring and emergency shutdown; **Zero-Liquid-Discharge** (tar condensate and scrubber blowdown captured and managed). No open burning at any stage.

3. The classification question

The unit could be read against either of two entries. I request confirmation of which one applies:

Candidate sector entry	Category	Consent regime
“Charcoal production from coconut shell by pyrolysis” (Notification dated 10.08.2024)	ORANGE	Consent to Establish + Consent to Operate; periodic monitoring

Candidate sector entry	Category	Consent regime
General charcoal / char (biochar) production — as I understand it is classified under the revised list as on 29.12.2025	GREEN	Simplified consent regime

4. Why I submit the general (lighter) entry is the correct fit

- **Not “coconut shell.”** The feedstock is mixed agri-biomass, not a coconut-shell-only charge; the 10.08.2024 Orange entry is worded specifically for “coconut shell.”
- **Not “charcoal” for fuel, nor activated carbon.** The product is biochar for soil; there is no oil/carbon-black recovery and no chemical/steam activation — the features that drive the heavier categories.
- **Low pollution potential on the CPCB Pollution-Index basis.** A closed, continuous process with afterburner, scrubber, controlled stack emissions and Zero-Liquid-Discharge has a materially lower Pollution Index than the coconut-shell charcoal / activated-carbon activities.
- **Guideline-compliant by design.** The unit is designed to meet the “Environmental Guidelines for Charcoal Manufacturing Units” dated 02.12.2025 (emission control, stack, ash/dust housekeeping, heat reutilisation, responsible feedstock sourcing).

5. Clarifications requested

I respectfully request the Board to clarify, in writing:

1. **The applicable entry and category.** Whether the described agri-biomass biochar (soil-amendment) unit falls under the general charcoal/char (biochar) production entry (Green) in the revised list as on 29.12.2025, rather than the “charcoal production from coconut shell by pyrolysis” (Orange) entry of 10.08.2024.
2. **If Orange is held to apply,** the consent conditions, and whether the unit is eligible for the self-certification route under the 16.09.2025 circular at my capital-investment level.
3. **The applicable technical norms** (emission limits, minimum stack height, distance/siting criteria) under the 02.12.2025 charcoal guidelines that I must design to.
4. **Confirmation that no public hearing or Environmental Clearance** is required for the unit (being outside the Red / EIA-2006 scheduled category).

6. Enclosures

- Brief project note / DPR extract (concept, capacity, mass balance).
- Process-flow and emission-control schematic (afterburner → cyclone → scrubber → stack; ZLD line).
- Feedstock list and plot details (survey no., extent, land-use, setbacks).

An early written clarification will let me file a correctly-categorised Consent to Establish and design the unit to the exact norms. I shall be glad to furnish any further particulars or meet the concerned officer at the District Office.

Thanking you,

Yours faithfully,

Arun T. — Proprietor

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